Northwind Cloud Employee Handbook

Version 4.2 · Effective 1 January 2026

1. Working hours and remote work

Our core collaboration hours are 10:00 to 16:00 CET, Monday to Friday. Outside those hours you are free to organise your own schedule.

Northwind Cloud is a remote-first company. Employees may work from any country in the European Union for up to 90 days per calendar year without prior approval. Working from outside the EU requires written approval from your manager and the People team at least 14 days in advance.

Contractors follow the hours agreed in their individual statement of work and are not covered by the remote work allowance in section 4.

2. Paid time off

Full-time employees receive 25 days of paid vacation per year, plus the public holidays of their country of residence. Up to 5 unused vacation days can be carried over to the next year and must be used before 31 March.

Vacation requests of more than 5 consecutive working days must be submitted at least 3 weeks in advance through the HR portal.

3. Sick leave and family leave

If you are ill, notify your manager before 10:00 on the first day of absence. A medical certificate is required for absences longer than 3 consecutive working days.

Parents receive 20 weeks of fully paid parental leave, regardless of gender, which can be taken within 12 months of the birth or adoption.

4. Equipment and remote work allowance

New employees receive a one-time home office budget of EUR 1,200 for a desk, chair, monitor and other equipment. Receipts must be submitted within 60 days of your start date.

In addition, every employee receives a monthly remote work allowance of EUR 60 to cover internet and electricity. The allowance is paid automatically with your salary.

Company laptops are replaced every 3 years. Lost or stolen devices must be reported to security@northwind.example within 24 hours.

5. Expenses and travel

Business travel must be booked through the travel tool. Economy class is standard for flights under 6 hours; premium economy may be booked for longer flights.

Meals during business travel are reimbursed up to EUR 55 per day. Expense reports must be submitted within 30 days, with an itemised receipt for every expense above EUR 10.

6. Learning budget

Each employee has an annual learning budget of EUR 1,000 for courses, books and conferences, plus 3 paid learning days per year. Unused budget does not roll over.

7. Security

Multi-factor authentication is mandatory on all company accounts. Customer data must never be copied to personal devices or personal cloud storage. Report suspected phishing to security@northwind.example.